



Canvio Connect

Toshiba unveiled Canvio Connect, a portable hard drive that lets you access, share and back up your files anywhere, anytime. <http://dgit.in/1613KXN>



Email.biz

It offers a cloud based login, multiple login, 20GB of storage, single / double letters domain support, and much more. <http://www.email.biz>

at boosting its marketing effort in the subcontinent and to this end ropes in Bollywood rising stars Parineeti Chopra and Varun Dhawan as brand ambassadors.

The campaign heavily focus on the app's voice messaging feature amongst others such as group chat, moments and special emoticons. The voice messaging feature or 'Hold-To-Talk' as its called is supposed to be a feature unique to WeChat while Moments allows WeChat where to post images or text and share with their selected friends in a secure way.

One of the biggest questions to come to mind is why is Tencent (WeChat's parent company) spending big bucks on endorsements and TV commercials? What could be the revenue model at play here? "Currently the focus of WeChat is on product improvement and growing the user engagement. WeChat has already caught the imagination of the youth and also of organizations in India. On using it, they understand the value WeChat provides to them. When we gather sufficient mass, that would be the time to discuss the revenue model and we shall surely share details with you," said Mr. Rahul Razdan, Head of Tencent India. Furthermore Mr. Dennis Hau, Head of International Product Center, Tencent International Business Group made it a point to assure the audience that "WeChat will remain free."

One of the possible ways to monetise the app could be in the form of a feature called "Official Accounts" which helps companies "companies and merchants to build interactivity with their fans in a new and innovative way". Brands like Café Coffee Day, Big Bazaar, Tradus and others have already started



with their Official Accounts on WeChat in India.

The app already had a soft launch last year in July 2012, when WeChat was made available in India across iPhone, Android, Symbian, and Windows Phone platforms. Few members of Team Digit tried out the app and found that no more than eight contacts from each of our address books were using the app. The app's 190 million strong active user-base doesn't yet include too many Indians, we figure. And hopefully this new campaign will change things upwards for WeChat.

Facebook Home reaches 1mln downloads, gets minor update

Social networking giant Facebook announced that its new Facebook Home app launcher for Android has reached a not so massive figure of one million downloads in just a month. Facebook initially launched the home screen app launcher a month back, within 10 days of its launch, it passed the 500,000 downloads mark and has added 500,000 more in 3 weeks.

With decent download statistics in such a short period, Facebook is also seeding out a minor update for Facebook Home. As of now there isn't anything unique about the update

apart from a minor bug fixes and improvements in performance. Facebook will however be rolling out more updates in the coming months that will enhance user experience. The new updates will include dash bar, very similar to an IM buddy list that will be used for Chat Heads. Facebook Home is currently compatible with devices which include the Samsung Galaxy S III, Samsung Galaxy S4, Samsung Galaxy Note II, HTC One and HTC One X.

However, Android users appear disappointed by the Facebook Home app launcher with a majority giving it a bad rating on the Google Play store. The average review on Google Play is 2/5 stars for the software. Going through the user reviews reveals that while some users find Facebook Home worthwhile, many others have criticized it for negatively affecting battery life, limited customization options and hogging mobile data.

Apple's App Store Marks Historic 50 Billionth Download

Apple in May announced that customers have downloaded over 50 billion apps from the



App Store. Customers are downloading more than 800 apps per second at a rate of over two billion apps per month on the App Store. The 50 billionth app was Say the Same Thing

by Space Inch, LLC, which was downloaded by Brandon Ashmore from Mentor, Ohio who received a \$10,000 App Store Gift Card to commemorate the historic milestone.

"Apple would like to thank our incredible customers and developers for topping 50 billion apps downloaded," said Eddy Cue, Apple's senior vice president of Internet Software and Services. "The App Store completely transformed how people use their mobile devices and created a thriving app ecosystem that has paid out over nine billion dollars to developers. We're absolutely floored to cross this milestone in less than five years."

The App Store opened in July 2008 with 500 apps. Since its introduction, Apple's incredible developer community has created an app for doing almost everything imaginable on an iPhone, iPad and iPod touch.

"We were blown away with our success on the App Store back in 2008," said Rich Riley, CEO of Shazam. "And almost five years later we continue to be amazed with how much people love using Shazam on their iPhone or iPad. With the App Store, we can effortlessly provide users with updates that give them great new features while making it easy for new users to discover and download Shazam for themselves."

The Apple App Store offers more than 850,000 apps to iPhone, iPad and iPod touch users in 155 countries around the world, with more than 350,000 native iPad apps available. App Store customers can choose from an incredible range of apps in 23 categories, including newspapers and magazines offered in Newsstand, games, business, news, sports, health & fitness and travel. 